

7.1.3 What happens when I dial my ISP?

Internet connectivity through a dial-up service works in a different manner. First of all, you don't need an Ethernet card, so you aren't assigned a private IP. Your PC becomes an isolated node until you dial in to an ISP.

A modem and a clear (without disturbance), functioning telephone line are required to establish a connecting via dial-up. The process is very simple: you have an account with your ISP. Using a dialler as a client, you can dial in to your ISP. Modem-to-modem interaction takes place, and your username and password are verified by the server at the ISP. The connection is first authenticated, and you are allowed to enter the ISP's server. Thereafter, your account is given a random (public) IP address so you can surf the Internet. All this happens in just a few seconds. Once you are connected to the Internet via dial-up, open the Konsole or gnome-terminal window and check the IP address you've been assigned by using the command "ifconfig".

7.2 Configuring Internet Access

Setting up a Linux machine to connect to the Internet is not a difficult task. And once you do, we bet you'd like to play around with additional settings such as spoofing the MAC address. Connection to the Internet can be achieved in different ways; here we shall see how to establish a connection through Ethernet and through dial-up.

7.2.1 Through Ethernet

Most broadband services in India have a standard setup that involves networking of PCs to a proxy server through which they get Internet access. The ISP gives every user an IP address, Gateway address and DNS address. Once you have this information, all you need to do is set up the network card.

During installation, one of the steps involves setting up of the network adapter. It is set by default to run at boot as a DHCP client.